

HTC Music Streaming Service

HTC is supposedly working on a music streaming service as a step forward together in its partnership with Beats <http://bit.ly/xEDQX7> Audio.

Google TV YouTube Updated

Google has released an update for its YouTube app on Google TV, with better content discoverability and community interaction. <http://bit.ly/wS73AL>

Google to launch **Drive cloud storage service soon**

Google is looking to launch its own cloud storage service in the near future, according to a report by the Wall Street Journal. The new cloud service will be called Google Drive, and will be geared towards easy access across multiple types of portable and desktop devices.

Google Drive, taking on Dropbox and Apple iCloud, will reportedly allow storage of photos, documents and videos, and access via any Web-connected device. Sharing files will also be easy, with users able to pass on a link to the file via email. Drive is expected to be a free service, with paid premium

benefits like larger storage. The idea of a Google cloud storage service has apparently been in the works for years, with a project internally known as G Drive doing the rounds in 2007. Since then, many services have been catering to the rapidly growing demand for cloud storage, and

Google was definitely a big player missing from the market.

Google apparently hopes to compete with Dropbox and other mobile-accessible cloud storage services, by offering much cheaper paid storage, leveraging its massive server farms. Integration with Google Docs is, of course, expected. **d**

Chemicals Behind **Facebook 'addiction'**

From time to time, you hear people make the tongue-in-cheek assertion that

they're "addicted" to Facebook. But recent data suggests that there might be some truth to such statements. A group of

researchers from the University of Milan and the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) identified chemical reasons at the root of the pervasive need to check social networks, Boy Genius Report has learned.

They found that users exhibit physical and psycho-

indicates that the Facebook experience was significantly different from stress and relaxation on many linear and spectral indices of somatic activity. Moreover, the biological signals revealed that Facebook use can evoke a psychophysiological state characterized by high positive valence and high arousal."

It added that it's possible users reach a "positive affective state" when they access their social networks.

The report comes the same week that a University of Chicago study found Facebook can be more addictive than cigarettes or alcohol.

With Facebook boasting 845 million users and Twitter at around 300 million, this research could be part of the reason for their enormous numbers. In fact, the researchers indicated that people seek out sites like Facebook and Twitter to receive this type of satisfaction, which has in turn, boosted their growth.

There's been no shortage of Facebook studies and another report released last week found that those with a low self-esteem suffer more by using the site, as posting negative items to Facebook often makes them appear less likable to their friends. **d**



physiological responses when they log onto Facebook, similar to the sensations experienced by people when they play an instrument or engage in some kind of creative activity.

Scientists monitored 30 subjects ages 19-25 as they looked at photos of nature, tried to solve math problems, and perused Facebook. They recorded physical reactions including skin conductance, blood volume pulse, electroencephalogram, electromyography, respiratory activity, and pupil dilation to uncover a pattern.

The study says: "Statistical analysis of the psychophysiological data and pupil dilation

Web censorship row: **Facebook, Google remove "offensive" content**

Google and Facebook have told a Delhi court that they've already removed offensive content from their sites. The court is hearing a civil suit filed by a Delhi resident Vinay Rai against 21 internet companies including Yahoo and Orkut for allegedly hosting objectionable content. Google and Facebook had earlier told the Delhi High Court that it was impossible for them to monitor content with billions of people accessing the web sites.

During the court hearing, another legitimate question was raised – whether blog-service providing companies should also be made a party to the case for posting offen-

sive content posted by their users on blogs.

The web censorship row came into the limelight in December last year after the court issued summons to the social networks over the "anti-religious" and "anti-social" content they hosted. The government previously has made various attempts at removing such content from the internet. Google, however, refuses to oblige stating that it won't simply delete content because it's controversial.

It now looks like Google has softened its stance on the ongoing censorship row in India. It may be recalled that both Twitter and Google recently have come up with country-specific content filtering mechanisms. **d**